

peoplestrongⁱ



Travel and Reimbursement Policy

Version - 3

Calendar 2025-26



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1. Statement of Purpose

1.1 Objective

The objective of this policy is to define the approval process/entitlements of employees who are traveling for official purposes within India or internationally. All travel must be done in accordance with this policy to qualify for reimbursement. Exceptions, if any, must be approved in advance as per the approval matrix defined in this policy.

1.2 Scope

This policy is applicable to all full-time employees of PeopleStrong. The policy is effective from 1st April 2025 till 31st March 2026 to all employees for official duties, including on deputation. The company has a right to change any of the parameters without any prior notification. The policy supersedes any earlier policy/amendments pertaining to business travel.

1.3 Purpose

The policy is designed to provide guidelines around all domestic(outstation/local) and international visits.

- a) To describe the types of expenditures that are reimbursable by the company.
- b) To describe the process for an employee to file travel expenses and obtain reimbursement(s).

This benefit is not considered as Income for an employee and does not form part of the total compensation package of an employee.

1.4 Roles and Responsibilities

1.4.1 Responsibility of the Employee

- a. All domestic travel on official work needs to be duly authorized by the respective Practice Head and Function Head. Additionally, approval from Head – People and Culture and CFO or CEO is required for international travel.
- b) Any travel requisition and travel expense form need to be filled online on PeopleStrong HRMS (Work Life). Employees must submit the form, furnished with necessary details. The form must be authorized by the respective Practice Head and Function Head.
- c) All travel expense statement(s) must be submitted by the employee within 10 days of his/her return along with supporting bills. This claim needs to be raised on the HRMS portal. Hard copies of the approved bills must be submitted online to the finance team for verification.
- d) Employees must ensure they have the required approvals wherever needed for travel and ensure all travel arrangements are made in advance.
- e) While as a general practice, all travel arrangement requests must be done through the admin team (Lifeline team) wherever possible, in case an employee has to spend, all such claims for reimbursement of hotel stay, air fare, railway (including tatkal), food, petrol and laundry should be supported by receipts, bills, tickets etc. and shall be based only on the actual expenses, subject to limits specified.

- f) If the accommodation and travel booking is being made directly by the employee, and not through Lifeline, the same must be approved by the Head – People and Culture and the Function Head.
- g) Employees must act professionally and adhere to the organization Code of Conduct.

1.4.2 Responsibility of the Approver(s)

- a) The primary responsibility and authority to implement and enforce this policy is placed with each manager whose team members incur travel expenses.
- b) It is the manager's responsibility to ensure that all travel expense claims are approved in accordance with this policy.

1.4.3 Responsibility of the HR Team

The primary responsibility is to have the policy available to employees for reference and build a strict governance framework around it.

1.4.4 Responsibility of the Finance Team

The primary responsibility of the finance team is to verify expense, reimbursement claim and highlight deviations, if any

1.4.5 Responsibility of the Lifeline Team

The admin/Lifeline team's main responsibility is to assist employees with accommodation, travel arrangements and visa(s), where possible.

2. Definitions

a. Domestic Travel: Any travel that is restricted to the states within India classify as Domestic Travel. Within domestic travel, if the travel is undertaken within the base city of the employee, it classifies as Intra – city travel. Travel between two different cities is inter–city travel.

b. International Travel: Any travel outside of India is classified as international travel for the purpose of this policy. Please refer to the guidelines in the International Travel Section of this policy.

c. Basis the duration, domestic travel may further be divided in to two categories:

- i. Short Term Travel: Travel up to 30 days in duration
- ii. Long Term Travel: Travel beyond 30 days to up to 1 year in duration
- iii. Permanent Transfer: Employee is expected to relocate to a new place for at least 1 year, with an option to relocate with her/his family. This type of travel will be covered for benefits under the Domestic/International Relocation Policy.

d. Family: For this policy, family means spouse and children of the employee.

Domestic Travel Policy

Snapshot of Domestic Travel Policy

- Raising a Travel Expense

- Any travel requisition e.g., air/rail booking, accommodation, car rentals etc. must be made online on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife).
- Once the domestic travel requisition is raised through HRMS, the request must be approved by the Practice Head and Function Head.
- The eligibility matrix for the various modes of transport is as given below:

Mode	Across All Work Level & Grades
Rail	2 nd AC
Car Rentals	Economy package
Air	Economy

- All employees are entitled to economy class flights. Requests for Air travel must be made at least 10 days in advance, to avoid last minute surge pricing.

- Cancellation

- In case of cancellation of the ticket/missing of flight for any journey due to default/negligence of employee, the cost of the same may be recovered from the salary of respective employee.

- Road Transport

- For shorter routes that take not more than 4 – 6 hours, an overnight direct train is recommended.
- Road travel should be opted for only if it is the most economically logical and efficient mode of travel available. However, driving beyond 7PM shall require the approval of the respective manager.
- For local travel by own vehicle for customer visits, within the base location, reimbursement shall be made as per the table below:

Vehicle	Rate of Reimbursement
2-wheeler – Scooter/bike	INR 5 per km
4-wheeler – Car	INR 11 per km

*No reimbursement shall be made for travel between home and base office location.

- If travel by road is a more convenient or efficient means to travel in case of inter-city travel, the employee may either book a rental through Lifeline on PeopleStrong HRMS (WorkLife) using the process flow defined on the previous page. The URL for HRMS: <https://hrms.peoplestrong.com/>
- In case of emergency travel, except for WL4 and WL5, exception approval needs to be taken from Practice Head and Function Head for Operations team and Function head for rest of the teams.

- Accommodation

- Hotel expenses would comprise expenses relating to the employee's stay in a hotel/service. In the case of accommodation of over 20 days, a service apartment arranged by the internal admin team with a maximum rental of INR 35000 per month will be arranged. Laundry Expenses can only be claimed on long stays i.e., minimum of five business days. Meal reimbursement is applicable during business trips to compensate employees for meal expenses.

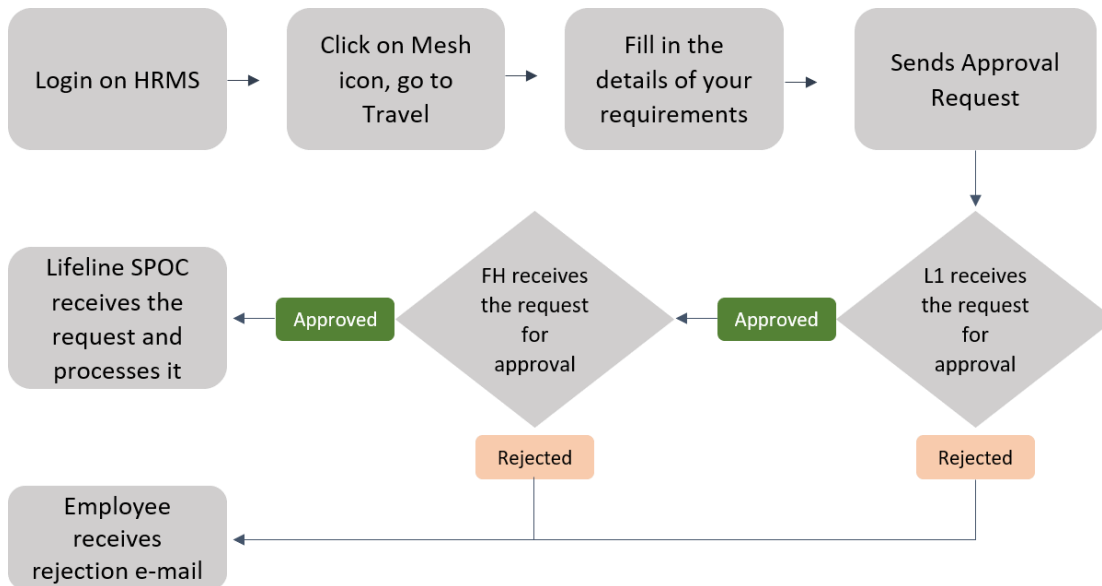
Meal Expense Reimbursement (INR per day)		
Category of Cities	Metro	Non – Metro
WL4 and above	On Actuals	On Actuals
WL3 and below	INR 1200	INR 1000

- Other Expenses

- Any sort of entertainment expense must be settled by the individual directly and will not be reimbursed.
- There is no provision for mobile bill reimbursement. However, in select roles within the Operations team, subject to the role requirement and after getting prior approval from the Practice head and Function Head, it will be permissible.
- To get the travel expenses reimbursed the employee must submit all the claims within 10 days from the date of completion of travel.
- In case there is a group travelling from one location to another, a group member may make a group travel request in HRMS.
- Advance travel amount, if any, will be transferred to employee's bank account via NEFT.

1. Tour Arrangements

- a) Any travel requisition e.g., air/rail booking, accommodation, car rentals etc. must be made online on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife).
- b) The navigation below can be used for booking travel by air, train or local transport and, accommodation.



1.1 Tour Authorization

Once the domestic travel requisition has been raised through HRMS, the request is approved as per the following approval matrix:

- a) Level 1 approval – Practice Head
- b) Level 2 approval – Function Head

The standard travel expense authorization matrix, as updated from time to time, of the company shall apply.

- a. International travel must be additionally approved by Head – People and Culture, CFO and CEO. Any exception to this policy requires approval from the Head – People and Culture.

1.2 Tour Cancellation

- a) Employees are expected to plan their travel at least 10 days in advance and avoid last-minute cancellations.
- b) Customer meetings/reviews/ Training calendars need to be set well in advance and followed to avoid the need for any cancellations/cases of urgent travel.
- c) In case of cancellation, employee must inform the Lifeline team immediately and raise a formal request for cancellation with them.

2. Eligibility

The eligibility matrix for the various modes of transport is as given below:

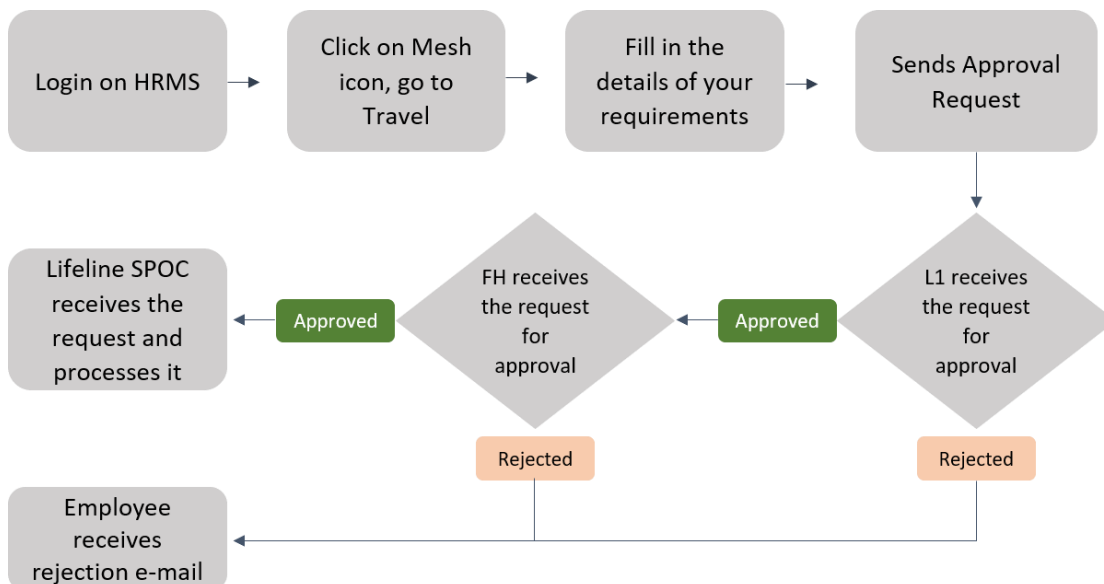
Mode	Across All Work Level & Grades
Rail	2 nd AC
Car Rentals	Economy package
Air	Economy

The mode of travel should be the most economically logical and efficient option of the above 3 modes.

Booking travel on HRMS

- All travel requests must be made online through Lifeline on PeopleStrong HRMS (WorkLife) using the process flow defined on the previous page.

URL for HRMS: <https://hrms.peoplestrong.com/>



In case of any change in plan while on tour, employee must share a cancellation request at the earliest with the Lifeline team to avoid any penalty or charges.

2.1 Air Travel

- All employees are entitled to economy class flights unless one-way travel time is more than 10 hours direct flight. In such cases, premium economy or economy plus can be opted for.
- Requests for Air travel must be made at least 10 days in advance, to avoid last minute surge pricing. Any exceptions to this must be approved by the Function Head or Head – People and Culture or CFO. Every effort should normally be made to take advantage of discounts and saver tickets.
- Customer meetings/reviews/ Training calendars need to be set well in advance and followed to avoid any need for any cancellations/cases of urgent travel.
- In case of cancellation of the ticket/missing of flight for any journey due to default/negligence of employee, the cost of the same may be recovered from the salary of respective employee.
- Unauthorized upgrading of air tickets from economy-to-economy premium or economy

premium to business class is considered a personal expense and will not be reimbursed by PeopleStrong.

- f. Fees for seat assignments/ early boarding etc., are not reimbursable.
- g. Employee may not downgrade air tickets to subsidize personal travel or to subsidize travel for non PeopleStrong individuals. In addition, changes will not be made to travel to subsidize another portion of travel – cost savings in one area may not be used to subsidize upgrades/or other spend.
- h. If there is no incremental cost to PeopleStrong, employees may use personal mileage benefits to upgrade reservations directly with the supplier after ticketing. Employees shall NOT request higher coach fares to qualify for an upgrade. Use of personal miles for business travel is not reimbursable.

2.2 Train Travel

For shorter routes that take not more than 4 – 6 hours and an overnight direct train is available, preference shall be given to travel by train even though the employee is entitled to air travel. All employees across work levels and grades are entitled to travel by 2nd AC travel or Chair Cars.

2.3 Road Travel

1. Road travel should be opted for only if it is the most economically logical and efficient mode of travel available.
2. Driving beyond 7 PM shall require specific approval of the Reporting Manager. Women employees are advised to undertake road travel between 7 AM to 7 PM as a safety measure.
3. Long-distance night travel by road post 10 PM is not advisable as a safety measure.

3. Local Travel

For local travel by own vehicle for customer visits, within the base location, reimbursement shall be made as per the table below:

Vehicle	Rate of Reimbursement
2-wheeler – Scooter/bike	INR 5 per km
4-wheeler – Car	INR 11 per km

*No reimbursement shall be made for travel between home and base office location. More details are mentioned below:

S No.	Scenario	To the destination	Return
1	An employee going from office to a client place and then drive to home	Distance from office to client place will be reimbursed	This will not be reimbursed
2	An employee going from home to a client place and then drive to home	This will not be reimbursed	This will not be reimbursed
3	An employee going from home to a client place and then drive to office	Distance from client place to office will be reimbursed	This will not be reimbursed
4	An employee going from office to a client place and then drive to office	Distance from office to client place will be reimbursed	Distance from client place to office will be reimbursed

* Parking/Toll expense will not be additionally reimbursable for road travel which is less than 100 km one way. However, for road travel greater than 100 km, it shall be reimbursable on actuals over and above the rate defined above.

- a) If travel by road is a more convenient or efficient means to travel in case of inter-city travel, the employee may either book a rental through Lifeline on PeopleStrong HRMS (WorkLife) using the process flow defined on the previous page. The URL for HRMS: <https://hrms.peoplestrong.com/>. Alternatively, they can use their own vehicle and claim petrol reimbursement basis the distance covered (Refer section 3.5)
- a) For local travel, employees are encouraged to use app-based cab services for point-to-point travel for client visits or other official purposes and claim reimbursement on the actual bill including the tolls.
- b) App based cabs should be the first preference of an employee for pick and drop from airport or customer visit. In case it is not feasible for some specific reason then as an alternative depending upon the requirement, the employee can request a cab from the Administration helpdesk.
- c) No claims can be made for travel to regular/base place of work.

Emergency Travel and Services

- a. Emergency travel can be requested for family and health exigencies when the employee needs to return to the base location on an urgent basis.
- b. In case of emergency travel, except for WL4 and WL5, exception approval needs to be taken from Practice Head and Function Head for Operations team and Function head for rest of the teams.

4. Accommodation

- Hotel expenses would comprise expenses relating to the employee's stay in a hotel/service apartment due to business travel in another city/state/country.
- Request for accommodation must be made online through HRMS.
- In case accommodation is to be planned for a stay of 20 or more days, service apartments should be preferred. The recommended rental per month for service apartments cannot exceed INR 35000 per month. (Any excess amount would need to be borne by the employee themselves)
- The arrangement for service apartments shall be facilitated by the internal admin team (Lifeline Team)
- All hotel bills will be Bill to Company. In case, for any reason, the stay is not at the network hotels, the employee can make the payment while checking out and claim reimbursement, as per policy.
- Laundry expenses can be claimed only if the stay exceeds more than 5 days. All claims are subject to supporting documents submitted.
- Reason for cancellation can only be on valid grounds of family emergency, unfavorable weather conditions or any other exigency without control. The same should be approved by the Practice Head.
- In the case where employees are travelling from the company to any location for business purposes, the room allocation will be based on a twin-sharing basis, and they will be sharing rooms with another colleague of the same gender.

4.1 In cases where the cost is borne by the customer or is OPE, the following is the scenario:

PeopleStrong – For internal purpose

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- **Cost Borne by the Customer:** In cases where the customer bears the cost of the accommodation, the room or the travel policy shall be per the guidelines set forth by the respective customer. It is essential to adhere to the customer's instructions to maintain a seamless relationship and ensure alignment with their policies.
- **Out-of-Pocket Expense (OPE):** In cases where the customer specifies the expense as part of the OPE, prior approval from the customer is mandatory before proceeding with the room booking. Additionally, all such approvals must be communicated to the Lifeline Team, which oversees travel arrangements, to maintain transparency and record-keeping.
- **Approval Process for Customer-Specified Expense:** When the customer has indicated a specific expense amount in the contract for room allocation, bookings can only be made after obtaining approval from the respective practice Heads at the G8 level or above. This measure ensures accountability and proper oversight while also ensuring compliance with the customer's guidelines.

5. Other Expenses

5.1 Entertainment Expenses

As a matter of policy, bar/liquor bills, private telephone calls, papers, magazines, videos, charges for mini-bars and any other entertainment costs in hotels must be settled by the individual directly and will not be reimbursed.

PeopleStrong does not encourage its team members to partake in the consumption of alcohol, cigarettes/tobacco products and other products that are injurious to the health of the employees, and therefore will not pay for such consumption.

5.2 Laundry expenses during Hotel Stay

Laundry Expenses can only be claimed on long stays i.e., a minimum of five business days during a single trip. Corresponding bills would need to be furnished.

5.3 Medical Expenses

In case of any medical incident that might happen with the employee during the business trip while the employee is not present at the base location, PeopleStrong will take all the necessary and possible actions to either get medical attention provided to the employee wherever they may be or initiate an evacuation from the area if necessary.

5.4 Mobile Expenses

There is no provision for mobile bill reimbursement. However, in select roles in the Operations team, subject to the role requirement and after getting prior approval from the Practice head and Function Head, it will be permissible as per the limits given below. Reimbursement is subject to the submission of bill, and valid only for postpaid connections.

Work level	Grade	Amount (INR)/month	Domestic Limit
WL1 & WL 2	G1 to G7	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum INR 400
WL3 & above	G8 and above	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum INR 1000

****Subject to the supporting bill submitted by the employee**

Prior Approval: Employees seeking mobile bill reimbursement must obtain prior approval from their respective L1 Managers before submitting reimbursement requests.

Reimbursement Limits: The permissible reimbursement limits for mobile bills are mentioned in the below table.

Validity: Reimbursement requests will only be considered for postpaid mobile connections.

Submission Requirements: Employees must submit their original, itemized postpaid mobile bills on the HRMS. Bills should display the employee's name and the billing period.

Reimbursement Processing: Once the reimbursement request is received along with the necessary documents, the Finance department will review and process the request as per the payment cycle.

***All WL1 mobile reimbursements need to be approved by the respective L1 and L2 manager.**

****No reimbursement shall be provided for internet and broadband connections.**

6. Travel Reimbursements

6.1 Reimbursement of Hotel Expenses

The hotel/accommodation booking must be made through Lifeline. In a rare scenario where the employee must book her/himself, the same must be pre-approved by the practice head and the Function Head. In such cases, the per day room rental must not exceed INR 5000 (including taxes).

In such cases, the bill must be in the company name. The invoice must be in the company name (PeopleStrong Technologies Pvt. Ltd.) and the GST number (GST No. - 06AADCP8140Q1ZY).

6.2 Meal Reimbursement

- Meal reimbursement is applicable during business travels to compensate employees for meal expenses.
- This is also available to employees who do not opt for company arranged accommodation and choose to stay with friends/family in the place of travel. No per diem, however, is applicable in lieu of the stay arrangements.
- The entitlement for Meal expense reimbursement is as given below:

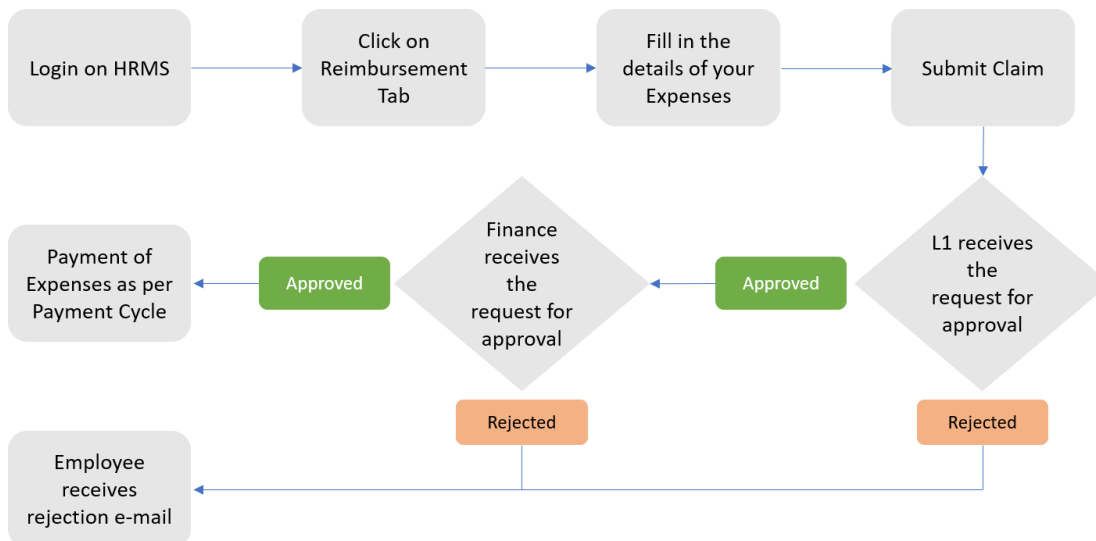
Meal Expense Reimbursement (INR per day)		
Category of Cities	Metro	Non – Metro
WL4 and above	On Actuals	On Actuals
WL3 and below	INR 1200	INR 1000

- Employees travelling overnight between cities by rail/road are eligible to claim meals and incidental expenses as per actuality, subject to limits specified and submission of actual bills. The meal expense reimbursement does not cover the expenses made for consumption of alcohol/alcoholic beverages.
- There will be no reimbursement of meal expenses for travel within 60 km (one way) of the base location (exceptions may apply under certain scenarios).
- The meal bill must be of the same date for which the reimbursement is being claimed.
- In case the employee loses the bill, no reimbursement shall be made.

Reimbursement Claims

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For Travel Expenses, employees are required to follow the below process to claim reimbursement of the same:



Best Practices

1. All expense claims must be submitted within 10 days from the date of completion of the travel.
2. In case an advance has been drawn but there is a change in the travel plan by more than one week, the advance taken should be returned forthwith.
3. To optimize the travel costs, the following considerations will be observed to the extent possible:
 - Reducing need for travel by increasing audio/video conference usage
 - Better Travel Planning for availing of nominal fares offered by airlines or taking overnight journeys by train wherever possible. As far as possible, travel should be planned in a manner that does not require overnight stay.
4. If the employee is working from home (or a location other than the base location) for personal reasons, in the case of travel, no cab expense shall be payable from home to the nearest airport or railway station and back. Further, air travel expense equivalent to the travel from base location (and not home location) to the destination only will be borne/reimbursed by the company. Any differential shall have to be borne by the employee.

Group Travel – Business Trips/Conferences

In case there is a group travelling from one location to another, a group member may raise a group travel request in HRMS. This will be applicable only if the group is using the same mode of travel. The boarding/lodging approval process and expense settlement, however, in this case will be separate for each employee.

Joint travelers should submit their travel bills individually. Employees can then settle their personal accounts off-line after the reimbursement, independently.

7. Tour Advance

- a) Employees may avail themselves of tour advances for the number of days for which she/he is undertaking official travel.
- b) An employee will be majorly incurring expenses on local conveyance, food, and laundry while on tour.

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- c) The maximum advance amount to be paid to the employees will be equivalent to their one month's salary.
- d) The employees must settle their previous travel advance within 10 days of the travel's completion.
- e) Excess amount, if any, which is spent by the employees from their own pocket, upon submission of bills and after verification by the Finance team will be reimbursed to the employee.
- f) Advance amount will be transferred to employee's bank account via NEFT.

International Travel Policy

Snapshot of International Travel Policy

- **International travel is categorized in to three types:**
 - Short – Term travel: Travel to international locations up to 60 days duration
 - Long – Term travel: Travel beyond 60 days duration, max up to one year.
 - Permanent Transfer: Employees going on contract for over 1 year.
- **Terms of Booking**
 - All employees across work levels and grades are eligible for Economy flight only. The flight booking requisition must be made on “Travel Request” module available in Mesh icon on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife), at least 3 weeks prior to the intended date of travel.
 - The travel desk will help you through the work permit/visa process.
 - In case of long-term travel and permanent transfer, hotel accommodation will be provided for the first 3 weeks, post which the employee must find service apartment/self-rented apartment respectively for the remainder of the stay. The service apartment shall be reimbursable at USD 2000 per month.
 - Tickets should be booked at least 3 weeks in advance. For travel by economy class, the travel executive should ensure that whenever possible the excursion fare is availed.
 - An employee staying in the international location may incur expenses due to local travel, meals, and other incidentals.
- **Claiming Reimbursement**
 - Further, to enable tracking of expenses, details must be uploaded on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife)
 - a. To enable processing of tour claims, an approved travel expense statement should be submitted to Accounts, supported by originals of the following documents, as applicable:
 - i. Air Tickets
 - ii. Original Bills for boarding and lodging
 - iii. Original bills and documents in support of any other expenses claimed.
 - iv. Documents for conversion of foreign exchange taken into any other currency.
 - For the short term (up to 60 days) or long-term (max 1 year) the company will only(reimburse) fare for the direct route to the official destination. If an employee wishes to take the family along with the official tour expenses in that case will be borne by the employee.
- **Accommodation**

In the case of International Travel, accommodation is to be pre-booked. Reimbursement may be claimed only if the expenses were incurred due to an emergency/unforeseen circumstance, not exceeding USD 100 per room per night, subject to submission of bills. The same shall be approved by the Practice Head and the Function Head.

In the case where employees are travelling from the company to any location for business purposes, the room allocation will be based on a twin-sharing basis, and they will be sharing rooms with another colleague of the same gender.

In cases where the cost is borne by the customer or is OPE, the following is the scenario:

- Cost Borne by the Customer: In cases where the customer bears the cost of the accommodation, the room or the travel policy shall be per the guidelines set forth by the

respective customer. It is essential to adhere to the customer's instructions to maintain a seamless relationship and ensure alignment with their policies.

- **Out-of-Pocket Expense (OPE):** In cases where the customer specifies the expense as part of the OPE, prior approval from the customer is mandatory before proceeding with the room booking. Additionally, all such approvals must be communicated to the Lifeline Team, which oversees travel arrangements, to maintain transparency and record-keeping.
- **Approval Process for Customer-Specified Expense:** When the customer has indicated a specific expense amount in the contract for room allocation, bookings can only be made after obtaining approval from the respective practice Heads at the G8 level or above. This measure ensures accountability and proper oversight while also ensuring compliance with the customer's guidelines.

- **Travel Allowance**

- Any client entertainment expense must be approved by the Function. Laundry Expenses can only be claimed. Meal reimbursement is applicable during business travels to compensate employees for meal expenses. Mobile bills are not included as part of per diem but on standard international telecom packages.

Header	Amount With Bills	Amount without Bills
Meals and Refreshments excluding alcohol/cigarettes; Incidentals like laundry - (A)	Expenses payable per day (non- taxable) subject to submission of bills as per below limit a. Thailand, Vietnam, and India: USD 55 b. UAE, Indonesia, and Philippines: USD 65 c. Rest of the countries: USD 75	Per diem payable specific to the country/region. Taxable as per the host country's tax regulations. a. Thailand, Vietnam, and India: USD 21 b. UAE, Indonesia, and Philippines: USD 25 c. Rest of the countries: USD 28
Local Travel (over and above (A))	On Actuals, upon submission of bills – App based cab or local tube/Metro	No reimbursement without bills
Mobile Bills & internet (over and above (A))	On Actuals, upon submission of bills	No reimbursement without bills

- **Other Expenses**

- No expense other than the ones mentioned explicitly in this policy shall be covered/reimbursed by PeopleStrong.
- Laundry Expenses can only be claimed on long stays i.e., a minimum of five business days during a single trip. Corresponding bills would need to be furnished.
- The accommodation booked by the company will include breakfast and no separate bill will be reimbursed for the breakfast.
- If anyone opting for per diem without any bills in such cases accommodation will be provided excluding breakfast during the travel.
- In case of any medical incident that might happen to the employee during the business trip while the employee is not present at the base location, PeopleStrong will take all necessary

actions.

- As a part of international travel visa fees, local taxi cost, Advisory and Cost of vaccination, ATM and bank charges will be covered by the PeopleStrong.
- **Relocation Benefits**
 - In case any employee is moving to other location on secondment or deputation, their compensation and benefits will change as per the new country and law of the land.
 - In case employee has incurred the relocation expenses, reimbursement needs to be claimed within 3 months of movement / relocation post which it will lapse.
 - Every employee will be provided with travel insurance by the Travel Helpdesk for any category of travel.
 - The company will provide accommodation for the first 30 days post that employee must identify suitable accommodation. Rental advance of up to 2 months' base salary shall be payable, which will be recoverable from 3rd month onwards, in 6 equal monthly instalments.
 - For movement of personal belongings, the employee is entitled for up to half a container load of movement from the place of original posting to the new location only. The maximum limit to such transfer expense will be 1500 USD.
 - Employees on permanent transfer to an international location shall be required to be covered under the host country's medical insurance policy. Wherever PeopleStrong has an option to provide group/Individual medical cover, all employees in that country will be covered by default under the policy. A Total sum assured of USD 300,000 for self, spouse and up to 2 kids is given as part of the policy.
- **Repatriation**
 - Employees on permanent transfer to an international location shall be required to be covered under the host country's medical insurance policy.
 - If an employee is asked to repatriate within a year of movement to the international location for business reasons, they will be offered a role at the last drawn compensation in India. In case the employee changes the job in the new place within 24 months of relocating, all relocation expenses will be recoverable from the employee in full.

1. Type of travel

International travel is categorized in to three types:

- Short – Term travel: Travel to international locations up to 60 days duration.
- Long – Term travel: Travel beyond 60 days duration, max up to one year.
- Permanent Transfer: Employees going on contract duration of more than 1(one) year.

2. Mode of Travel & Eligibility

All employees across work levels and grades are eligible for Economy flight only.

The flight booking requisition must be made on "Travel Request" module available in Mesh icon on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife), at least 3 weeks prior to the intended date of travel. Necessary travel arrangements will be made by the internal admin team (Lifeline).

The centralized concierge (travel desk) will help facilitate international travel for our employees:

- Work permit/Visa and documentation formalities will be processed and supported by them.
- Visa application submission process will take 7-10 working days after receiving the documentation required as per the country norms.

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In the case of permanent transfer with family, necessary support will be extended to arrange Visa for employee's family too. Visa expenses, if any, will be borne by PeopleStrong for the family of the employee (Spouse + kids).

3. Tour Arrangements

3.1 Accommodation

The employees shall make a request for accommodation on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife) at least 3 weeks prior to the date of travel. The arrangement for accommodation shall be made by the internal admin team (Lifeline).

In case of short – term travel, once the employee raises a requisition for accommodation arrangements in Worklife, the Lifeline team will make necessary hotel bookings for the duration of stay.

In case of long-term travel and permanent transfer, hotel accommodation will be provided for the first 3 weeks, post which the employee must find service apartment/self-rented apartment respectively for the remainder of the stay. The service apartment shall be reimbursable up to USD 2000 per month.

3.2 Travel

The process of Pre-travel Booking for travel and accommodation in the case of International Travel remains the same as for domestic travel i.e., through HRMS. The below may be followed to initiate a Travel Requisition:

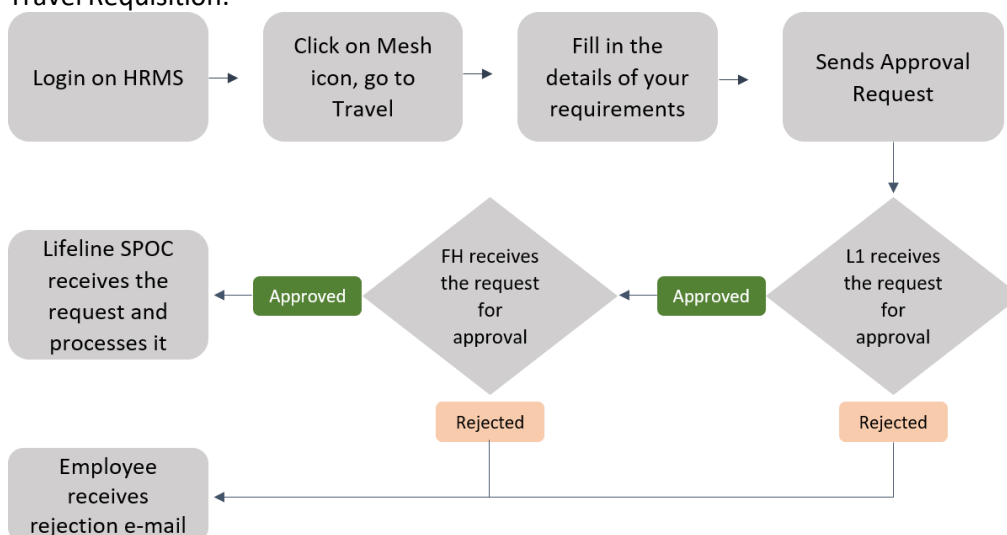


Fig. 3 Pre-Travel Booking Process - International

Terms for Booking

- Tickets should be booked at least 3 weeks in advance as last-minute tickets normally involve paying a premium. Every effort should normally be made to take advantage of discounts and saver tickets.
- Short haul flights mean flights with an in-flight time duration of up to or less than nine hours, from place of origin to destination. In-transit stopovers, flight changeovers, stopovers due to

any break in journey, unscheduled stoppages/delays, etc. are excluded and will not impact the definition. In – a flight time of more than 9 hours will be treated as a long-haul flight.

- c. For travel by economy class, the travel executive should ensure that whenever possible the excursion fare is availed.

4. Re-imbursement of Travel Expenses

For International Travel Expenses incurred by an employee, he/she is required to follow the below process to claim reimbursement of the same:

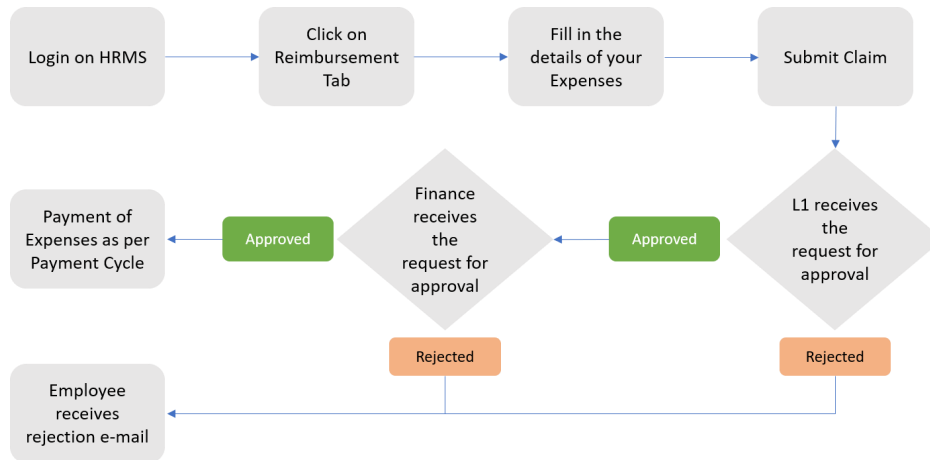


Fig. 4 Claiming Reimbursement of Expenses Process - International

Terms for Claiming Reimbursement of Travel Expenses – International

While the travel and accommodation arrangements must be made well in advance as per policy through the internal admin Team (Lifeline), an employee during stay in the international location may incur expenses on account of local travel, meals, and other incidentals.

For such cases, PeopleStrong shall provide pre-loaded forex cards. The cards shall be pre-loaded for weekly/monthly expenses, as per approval from the Practice Head and Function Head.

Further, to enable tracking of expenses, details must be uploaded on PeopleStrong HRMS (Worklife)

- b. All expenses, including fares, hotel expenses etc., related to a specific tour shall be filed by a single expense statement.
- c. All expense claims must be submitted within ten days of the date of completion of the travel.
- d. In case an advance has been made but there is a change in the travel plan of more than one week, the advance taken should be returned forthwith.
- e. To enable processing of tour claims, an approved travel expense statement should be submitted to Accounts, supported by originals of the following documents, as applicable:
 - i. Air Tickets
 - ii. Original Bills for boarding and lodging
 - iii. Original bills and documents in support of any other expenses claimed.
 - iv. Documents for conversion of foreign exchange taken into any other currency.

- f. All fields in the Travel Expense statement, e.g., the purpose of travel etc. should be filled in, to facilitate meaningful reporting.
- g. Any balance amount due to or for the company against any specific travel claim must also be settled by the employee at the time of submission of the expense statement.
- h. Employees are advised to use public transport – Metro, Tube, City Bus, etc. as the preferred Mode of Transportation over Cabs
- i. All expenditure on lodging & boarding must preferably be supported by documentary evidence. For any other business-related expenditure for which, in the normal course, a receipt/ document is available in support, the same must be obtained. For any unsupported expenditure, including expenditure on lodging & boarding, the same shall be paid without supporting vouchers only if the aggregate expenditure does not exceed the aggregate daily allowance (per diem allowance).
- j. For computing the permissible expenditure and allowance, the date of arrival shall be considered as the basis. However, any normal expenditure incurred while the executive is in transit at an international airport/ city (e.g., meals, telephones. Etc.) shall be reimbursed based on actuals.
- k. No deviation / exception in the allowance would normally be considered. However, under exceptional circumstances the same shall specifically be approved by the CEO / CFO or Head-People and Culture.
- l. In the event of any employee using a globally valid Credit Card to pay for her/his expenses on tour on company's business, he/she must ensure that:
 - i. country specific regulations if any, are scrupulously complied with in respect of its usage.
 - ii. Personal and Business expenditure are clearly segregated. (It will be preferable to use a separate credit card for incurring expenditure of a personal nature).
- m. Employees who travel by in a class lower than the class entitled should claim and will be paid only at the lower rate applicable to the class he/she has travelled in.
- n. These guidelines will not be applicable for any travel program that is part of a group conference, training program, etc., and which has a separate budgetary approval.
- o. For entertaining specific guests, such expenses should be claimed separately duly approved specifically as per guidelines in vogue.
- p. The travelling employee must enclose a tour report along with his claim/ adjustment of travel expenses.

4.1 Personal Extension or Family Travel

Short – Term or Long-Term Travel:

- The Company will only pay the fare for the direct route to the official destination.
- q. If an employee wishes to take the family along with the official tour, any additional expense including airfare and accommodation for the family will be borne by the employee, provided the vacation is also approved by the Business Head or Head-People and Culture in terms of leave and combining the same with the official tour.

- Per day allowance at the rate of USD 50 per day shall be payable (taxable) in case the employee does not use company accommodation for self. This shall be valid only for the duration of business travel, as approved by the Practice Head and the function head. In such a case, per diem will be taxable.

5. Travel Allowance

- A Travel Day refers to 24 hours, which begins when the employee leaves his/her city of workplace or residence and ends when they reach their city of workplace or town residence, as per boarding pass date.
- Per Diem is defined as the living allowance per travel day (including weekends and holidays) to cover the following, as per the employee's role. Per Diem will be payable upon submission of bills.

Travel Allowance Coverage
• Includes meals and refreshments, and daily provisions if staying in a service apartment (unless provided for at the hotel or by the company on a complimentary basis). • Does not include the purchase of alcohol, cigarettes, or any other banned substances.
• Incidental expenses like laundry. Local Travel is covered separately.
• Mobile bills - Not included as part of per diem but on standard international telecom package.
• Local travel covered on actuals - Employee to use the lowest online cab service and upload bills through the system.
• Client entertainment will be on a case-to-case basis and approved by the Function Head

- When an employee submits an expense report, whatever bills are submitted, the tax benefit will be passed on.
 - If bills expensed are not submitted, per diem shall be payable at the lesser amount, after deducting applicable taxes (as per taxation rules)
 - Per diems for a traveler will be pre-loaded for a week via forex card.
- Once an employee qualifies for per diem, as per the governing rules and policy, the employee is advised to retain copies of the expense proofs/bills, which may be required by the Finance department to comply with in country tax and regulations.

Summary:

Header	Amount With Bills	Amount without Bills
Meals and Refreshments excluding alcohol/cigarettes; Incidentals like laundry - (A)	Expenses payable per day (non- taxable) subject to submission of bills as per below limit a. Thailand, Vietnam, and India: USD 55 b. UAE, Indonesia, and Philippines: USD 65	Per diem payable specific to the country/region. Taxable as per the host country's tax regulations. a. Thailand, Vietnam, and India: USD 21

	c. Rest of the countries: USD 75	b. UAE, Indonesia, and Philippines: USD 25 c. Rest of the countries: USD 28
Local Travel (over and above (A))	On Actuals, upon submission of bills – App based cab or local tube/Metro	No reimbursement without bills
Mobile Bills & internet (over and above (A))	On Actuals, upon submission of bills	No reimbursement without bills

Reimbursement of Hotel Expenses

In the case of International Travel, accommodation is to be pre-booked. Reimbursement may be claimed only if the expenses were incurred due to an emergency/unforeseen circumstance(s), not exceeding USD 100 per room night, subject to submission of bills. The same shall be approved by the Practice Head and the Function Head.

6. Other Expenses

6.1 Entertainment Expenses

As a matter of policy, no expense other than the ones mentioned explicitly in this policy shall be covered/reimbursed by PeopleStrong. PeopleStrong does not encourage its team members to partake in the consumption of alcohol, cigarettes / tobacco products and other products that are injurious to the health of the employees, and therefore will not pay for such consumption.

6.2 Laundry Expenses during Hotel Stay

Laundry Expenses can only be claimed on long stays i.e., a minimum of five business days during a single trip. Corresponding bills would need to be furnished.

6.3 Medical Expenses

In case of any medical incident that might happen with the employee during the business trip while the employee is not present at the base location, PeopleStrong will take all necessary actions, as possible, to either get medical attention provided to the employee wherever they may be or initiate an evacuation from the area if necessary.

6.4 Other Related Expenses

As part of international movements, following expenses and arrangements will be covered by PeopleStrong:

- Visa fees and visa related incidental expenses incurred by employees.
 - Local taxi to and from airport transfers on transit days.
 - Advisory (information) on and cost of vaccinations if done as per the local requirement of the country.
 - ATM/Bank charges associated with cash withdrawals to be used for business expenses.
- r. Any other expense that is not explicitly called out in the policy will not be borne by PeopleStrong, unless pre – approved by the Function Head and Head – People and Culture.

7. Relocation benefits outside India

An employee may be required to relocate from his/her original place of posting to another location outside India for a specified or unspecified duration, due to exigencies of work and on business compulsions. This policy applies to any such relocation whose duration is minimum 12 months.

a) In case any employee is moving to other location on secondment or deputation, their compensation and benefits will change as per the new country and law of the land. In-case any employee decides to return to the base location within 12 months of the movement, the last compensation of an employee in his/her base location will be considered for all future purpose.

b) In case the movement is more than 12 months, company will initiate exit in the base location and all the benefits of the base location will be completed like full & final settlement (including gratuity). It will not be treated as continuity of employment. HR team will initiate new employee code for the new base location, and it will be considered as group transfer.

c) In case the movement is more than 12 months, employee will get two weeks paid vacation and return air fare for self, spouse and up to 2 kids. This benefit cannot be extended to Parents, siblings, or any other relation. The plan should be prepared and approved minimum three months in advance.

d) In case employee decides to return or exit job within 12 months of the movement, employee must return the entire relocation amount spent by the company during the transition/movement from base location.

Accommodation

The Company will provide accommodation for the first 30 days post that employee must identify suitable accommodation, in case of permanent transfers. In case any employee would like to continue the accommodation provided by the company, he/she needs to bear the cost beyond 30 days of stay. Rental advance of up to 2 months' base salary shall be payable, which will be recoverable from 3rd month onwards, in 6 equal monthly instalments.

Movement of Personal Belongings

For movement of personal belongings, the employee is entitled for up to half a container load of movement from the place of original posting to the new location only. The maximum limit to such transfer expense will be 1500 USD.

i. Leave during relocation: The employee will be entitled to 10 days of paid leave for the purpose of relocation. This leave cannot be carried forward, adjusted or encashed.

ii. Relocation Lump sum: The employee will be paid a one-time settling in allowance. For long term travel, employee will be entitled to USD 1000 as the allowance. For permanent movement, the employee will be entitled to USD 2000 if moving with the spouse and 3000 USD if with spouse and kids.

In case the employee is moving without family (spouse and kids), she/he will be entitled to one flight ticket back to the base location, once the employee has completed minimum 11 months in the new location.

Reimbursement of Relocation Expenses:

- a. In case employee has incurred the relocation expenses, reimbursement needs to be claimed within 3 months of movement / relocation post which it will lapse. Any claims for

reimbursement should be strictly as per policy, unless otherwise approved by the Function Head and Head - People and Culture.

Travel Insurance

Every employee will be provided with travel insurance by the Travel Helpdesk for any category of travel. The typical benefits extended are as follows.

*The list of benefits is only indicative and actual benefits may vary depending on the final insurance opted for.

Group /Individual Medical Insurance

Employees on permanent transfer to an international location shall be required to be covered under the host country's medical insurance policy. Wherever PeopleStrong has an option to provide group/Individual medical cover, all employees in that country will be covered by default under the policy. The total sum assured of USD 300,000 for self, spouse, and up to 2 kids is given as part of the policy.

In countries where the Group Medclaim policy is not available, PeopleStrong will be liable to pay for the reimbursement of premium for medical expense coverage of employees, spouse, and kids, up to a maximum premium of USD 4,000 per annum for the aforesaid coverage.

8. Repatriation (in case of permanent transfer)

If an employee is asked to repatriate within a year of movement to the international location for business reasons, they will be offered a role at the last drawn compensation in India.

In case an employee changes the job in the new place of joining within 24 months of relocating, all relocation expenses will be recoverable from the employee in full.

In case an employee completes the full tenure in the new place of posting or is asked to repatriate/move back by the organization after atleast an year of movement, nominal increase (as per employee's last rating and average increment %) will be given on the last drawn CTC in India.

Frequently Asked Questions

- a. Can I book a cab for the entire day for official purposes e.g., Going to different client offices?

Wherever feasible, an employee may only book a Cab (within city) from point to point (using app-based cab services) and not for the entire day/long hours. The Company in such case, shall not be liable to pay the Cab expenses.

- b. Can I book the travel tickets for an official tour myself?

In intercity, Inter-state and international travel, employees are advised to opt for Pre-Travel Booking via HRMS, which sends the request to the Lifeline Team for further processing. Only in exceptional cases, with the prior approval of Practice Head and Function Head, an employee may book travel by self and claim reimbursement.

- c. Is there a limit to the amount I can claim for reimbursement of expenses incurred on Travel?

While no limits have been set for Reimbursement of Travel Expenses, employees are expected to use reason while incurring such expenses and claiming reimbursement for the same.

d. How can I initiate a request for a travel related booking?

An employee can raise a request for travel booking by following steps:

- Login on HRMS
- Click on Mesh icon, go to Travel
- Fill in the details of your requirement.
- Send Approval Request

If approval from the respective L1 Manager and subsequently Function Head is received, the Lifeline Team processes the request and shares the travel details directly with the employee.

e. Is there any limit to the Mobile (Call) Bill amount claimed for reimbursement?

There is no provision for mobile bill reimbursement. However, in select roles in the Operations team, subject to the role requirement and after getting prior approval from the Practice head and Function Head, it will be permissible as per the limits given below. Reimbursement is subject to the submission of bill, and valid only for postpaid connections.

Work level	Grade	Amount (INR)/month	International Limit
WL1 & WL 2	G1 to G7	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum INR 800
WL3 & above	G8 and above	80% of the Total Bill	Maximum INR 2000

****Subject to the supporting bill submitted by the employee**

Prior Approval: Employees seeking mobile bill reimbursement must obtain prior approval from their respective L1 Managers before submitting reimbursement requests.

Reimbursement Limits: The permissible reimbursement limits for mobile bills are mentioned in the below table.

Validity: Reimbursement requests will only be considered for postpaid mobile connections.

Submission Requirements: Employees must submit their original, itemized postpaid mobile bills on the HRMS. Bills should display the employee's name and the billing period.

Reimbursement Processing: Once the reimbursement request is received along with the necessary documents, the Finance department will review and process the request as per the payment cycle.

***All WL1 mobile reimbursements need to be approved by the respective L1 and L2 manager.**

****No reimbursement shall be provided for internet and broadband connections.**

f. Can I claim expenses incurred on Client Entertainment during meeting(s) within the boundaries of my base-location?

Yes, an employee may claim expenses incurred on Client Entertainment (Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages) within reason. The approval for reimbursement of such expenses is subject to L1 Manager's approval followed by approval from the Finance Department.

- g. When should I initiate request for travel, Domestic or International?

In the case of Domestic Travel, an employee is required to initiate a travel request through HRMS atleast 10 days prior to the date of travel while in case of International Travel, the same should be done atleast 3 weeks in advance.

- h. I have misplaced my meal bills. How can I claim reimbursement?

Reimbursement can only be claimed on production of bills for the same date on which travel was undertaken.

- i. Can I claim toll charges and parking charges as well?

For distance(s) up to 100 km, toll and parking charges cannot be claimed separately. However, for road travel beyond 100 km, the same may be claimed upon production of bills.